

Teacher Guide: Challenges Stations

Grade 5 Writing

6 stations x 8 minutes

Learning target: I can identify how characters respond to challenges in a story.

Overview

This set gives students six different ways to practice the same target: identifying a character's challenge and explaining the character's response with text evidence. The tasks move from direct identification to sequencing, comparing, evidence selection, and a short written explanation.

Station	Primary purpose	Student evidence
1. Spot the Challenge	Identify challenge and response	Short answers + selected explanation
2. Put the Response in Order	Track response as a sequence of actions	Ordered steps + summary phrase
3. When the Plan Changes	Connect challenge to an adapted plan	Challenge/response table + why it works
4. Same Challenge, Different Responses	Compare two character responses	Evidence table + comparison
5. Match the Evidence	Distinguish response evidence from background details	Checked evidence + sentence completion
6. Explain the Response	Synthesize challenge, response, and evidence	3-4 sentence constructed response

Materials and setup

Common classroom materials only: one printed copy of each station per student/group, pencils, and a visible timer. Highlighters are optional at Stations 1 and 6. Clipboards may be used if students are moving around the room.

Place one station page at each location. Students can write directly on their own packet, or each group can carry individual response pages. A full rotation is 48 minutes. With a brief launch and wrap-up, plan for about one class period.

Suggested launch

Say: A challenge is a problem, obstacle, or difficult situation a character faces. A response is what the character thinks, says, decides, or does because of that challenge. Today, your job is to connect the challenge to the response and support your thinking with details from the text.

Remind students that a response can include more than one action. When a character changes a plan, tries again, asks for help, or makes a decision, those actions may all be part of the response.

Station facilitation notes

Station 1: Spot the Challenge

Look for students separating the problem (missing book) from Maya's response (remembering, checking, asking permission, retrieving it). If needed, ask: "What happened to Maya that she needed to solve? What did she do next?"

Station 2: Put the Response in Order

Students should notice that Nia does not simply "fix the bridge." She observes, records, changes the design, and retests. Ask students to point to the transition words or sentence order that helped them sequence the actions.

Station 3: When the Plan Changes

Emphasize the connection between the challenge and the adapted plan. Strong responses explain that the indoor photos and map allow Luis to communicate the same observations without going outside.

Station 4: Same Challenge, Different Responses

Students should compare responses, not personalities. Marcus waits and assumes the walk may be over; Ava studies the map and suggests another route. Accept precise paraphrases supported by the text.

Station 5: Match the Evidence

This station checks whether students can tell the difference between details that describe the challenge/background and details that show a response. The teacher's nod is not Mei's response; Mei's breathing, using the heading, and continuing are.

Station 6: Explain the Response

Use this as the strongest independent evidence of the target. A successful answer identifies the ramp problem and explains Sam's testing, adding rails, and raising the ramp, with at least two text details.

Fast formative check

Look for	Needs support	On target
Challenge	Retells events without naming the problem/obstacle.	Clearly states the problem/obstacle the character faces.
Response	Names an unrelated detail or only a feeling.	Names one or more actions/decisions taken because of the challenge.
Evidence	Uses vague language with no text detail.	Uses a specific detail that directly supports the identified response.

Wrap-up prompt

Ask: "What words could you use to explain the connection between a challenge and a character's response?"
Possible stems: **When** ____ happens, the character _____. / **Because** ____, the character decides to ____.